

The Truly-Mobile New FIELD TEST EQUIPMENT



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Used across industries for countless applications, field test equipment are compulsory tools in engineers' arsenal. Handheld test equipment, in particular, are preferred for field applications owing to their portability, ease of use and quick operation. To make the user experience better, manufacturers are taking a step forward towards improving their connectivity and ruggedisation.

Field testing across industries

Field test equipment find significant applications in industries like manufacturing, chemical, food, pharmaceuticals, automotive, and oil and gas to name a few. These devices are used to measure multiple characteristics like electrical, temperature, humidity and vibration. Each parameter requires a separate test equipment, making the list of these equipment quite exhaustive.

In an attempt to narrow down this list to the most common T&M devices, we spoke to Parag Yelegaonkar, business development manager, Testo India. Parag shared, "Some essential field testing equipment include multimeters, clamp meters, voltage testers, power analysers and harmonics analysers."

Field test equipment are essential for large-scale applications as well. Naray-

anan V., senior application engineer, Megger (India), explained: "Let's take the example of a power plant. It is full of equipment like transformers and motors. Field test equipment are used to test all these devices. A transformer has a lot of testing areas—the oil, windings, bushing and so on. Separate products are required to test these different areas. There are insulation resistance testers and distance testers for checking the winding. Then there are cable testers, oil testers, and devices for measuring the primary and secondary current."

India being a tropical country, a major focus is on humidity and air quality monitoring. Vimal Chhavda, sales manager, Testo India, informed, "Air quality monitors and stack emission monitors are in high demand. Thermal imaging cameras are also finding a lot of field applications." Aerospace, civil aviation, para-military forces and broadcasting industry use these instruments for network monitoring and optimisation.

Upgrade your setup

The rise of connected technology and interactive interfaces has reshaped the design protocol of field T&M equipment. Today's portable test devices incorporate some of the latest technologies. Emphasising on these transformations, Parag said, "Instruments are becoming smart. Earlier, users had to manually note down the readings while using these T&M instruments. Today's instruments have storage and connectivity facilities to store, acquire and analyse the data—locally or remotely with the help of software. This data is used for analytics and reporting purposes."

Going wireless with Bluetooth. The wireless era has driven the integration of Bluetooth chips onto T&M devices. Previously, to extract data from field test equipment, users needed to connect them to a computer system with compatible cables.

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